

Deconstructivism

The exponents of deconstructivism, which emerged around 1990, created spectacular forms that expressed their opposition to the ordered rationality of modernism and postmodernism. The name derived from the exhibition *Deconstructivist Architecture*, organized in New York by Philip Johnson in 1988, which featured the work of Frank Gehry (1929–), Peter Eisenman (b.1932), Rem Koolhaas (b.1944), Bernard Tschumi (b.1944), Daniel Libeskind (b.1946), Zaha Hadid (1950–) and the cooperative Coop Himmelb(l)au.

Deconstructivism is confrontational, bold and surprising. Tschumi coined the movement's motto as 'form follows fantasy' after Louis Sullivan's famous 'form follows function' (see here). Inspired by sources as diverse as the Russian constructivists and the theories of French philosopher Jacques Derrida, deconstructivist buildings are characterized by fragmentation, an interest in manipulating surfaces, and non-rectilinear shapes that seem to distort and dislocate the design.



Groninger Museum Pavilion, Coop Himmelb(l)au, 1994